

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 6 2
♥ Q 2
♦ 10 5 3 2
♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ 9 7

♥ A K 9 6

♦ A Q 9 7 4

♣ A 5



♠ 8 5 4

♥ J 4 3

♦ J 8 6

♣ 10 9 8 2

♠ A K Q J 3

♥ 10 8 7 5

♦ K

♣ K Q J

West	North	East	South
Pass	1♦	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♦
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♥

All Pass

6♥ by North

Lead: ♠4

Your 2♥ bid is a Reverse, showing 17+ points.

There has been no agreement on trumps, so you assume that South has implicitly agreed to ♥s. So you respond 5♣, showing 4 Key-Cards, three Aces and the ♥K. Partner next bids 5♦.

5♦ is the Queen Ask. Partner obviously is thinking about a Grand Slam and wants to know whether you hold the trump Queen (♥Q). Since you do not have the card you return to the agreed trump suit at the lowest level - which is 5♥. Partner now bids 6♥.

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 6 3
 ♥ A K 9 8 6 5
 ♦ K
 ♣ A 3 2

♠ Q J 5 2

♥ 7

♦ 9 6 4 3

♣ Q 8 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 7

♥ Q J 3

♦ A Q J 10 8 7 5

♣ K

♠ 10 9 8 4

♥ 10 4 2

♦ 2

♣ J 10 9 7 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Pass	2 ♦	Pass
3 ♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
5 ♣	Pass	5NT	Pass
6 ♦	Pass	7NT	

All Pass

7NT by East

Lead: ♣J

The bidding has been as shown. Yes, you could have jump-shifted on your first bid.

Slam in ♥s is almost certain, but you should check for Key-Cards. You bid 4NT and partner says 5 ♣.

Partner shows 1 or 4 Key-cards. Since he jumped on the second round you figure it must be 4. So you have all the Key-Cards. Time to find out about the other Kings, so you bid 5NT. Partner replies 6 ♦.

Partner has 1 King, the only one left, the ♦K. You can count about 17 high-card tricks available so you bid 7NT.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 7 3
♥ 7 4
♦ A 6 5 3 2
♣ 9 4

♠ —

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ K Q J 7 4

♣ J 10 8 3



♠ A J 9 5 4 2

♥ 5 2

♦ 9 8

♣ 7 5 2

♠ 10 8 6

♥ K Q J 8 3

♦ 10

♣ A K Q 6

Your 3♠ bid is a Splinter, agreeing ♥s as trump, and showing opening hand strength with a singleton or void in ♠s.

You have one Key-Card, the ♥A. You also have a ♠ void, but since bidding 6♠ would take you above the 6♥ level you just respond 6♥. Partner will deduce that your void is in ♠s, particularly because you Splintered in that suit. Partner passes your 6♥ bid.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			
Lead: ♠K			

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q J 9 6 5

♥ A K

♦ 8 7 5

♣ A 5

♠ 2

♥ 9 5 3 2

♦ A Q J 10 4

♣ Q 9 8



♠ A 10 8 4 3

♥ Q 10 8 4

♦ —

♣ K J 10 2

♠ 7

♥ J 7 6

♦ K 9 6 3 2

♣ 7 6 4 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♦

Pass

4NT

Pass

6 ♦

Pass

7 ♠

All Pass

7 ♠ by West

Lead: ♥ 3

Partner's 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid. It shows opening hand strength, at least 4-card ♠ support, and a singleton or void in ♦s.

Normally you would not ask for Key-Cards with this ♦ holding. But since you know partner has at most a singleton, and that it is not the singleton ♦ A, you are safe to do so. You say 4NT, partner replies 6♦. What next?

WOW! Partner has one Key-Card and a ♦ void. So the Key-Card is the ♠ A. You don't know what the rest of partner's hand is, but he can surely take care of that small ♣. You bid 7♠.